said. The two started a long-distance research collaboration, working on locality and the measurement problem. “We actually published a couple of papers in *Physical Review* together, by snail mail in those days, before we had ever met each other.”

But when Albert suggested that his work with Aharonov would make a good basis for a PhD thesis, the Rockefeller Physics Department balked. “I said to them, I’ve been working on this measurement problem stuff with Aharanov, I’d like to do my thesis about that,” Albert recalled. “A few days after that I was asked to come to the Dean’s office at Rockefeller, the Dean of Graduate Students, and told that under no circumstances was anybody going to do a thesis about that in the Physics Department at Rockefeller University, and if I further insisted on that, I was going to be kicked out of the program.” They handed Albert a different subject for his thesis. “It was a very calculation-heavy problem about Borel resummation in φ^4 field theory… which was clearly being assigned because it was thought it would be good for my character,” Albert said. “There was an explicitly punitive element there. And they said, here are your choices: you can do *this* problem and no other, or you can leave the program.”

After discussing it with Aharonov, Albert decided to stick it out at Rockefeller. “[Aharonov said] why don’t you just put your head down, do this problem that they’ve assigned to you, I can give you a postdoc at Tel Aviv as soon as you get your PhD, and you’ll be on your way,” Albert recalled. “And that’s what I did. But it was made very clear to me what the rules of the game were, and that there was to be no more talk about the measurement problem in the Physics Department at Rockefeller.”

Ultimately, Albert used his postdoc with Aharonov as a launchpad to switch careers to philosophy of physics. But other physics students interested in foundations were not so lucky. And the means used to suppress inquiry into the foundations of quantum physics were not merely limited to career stagnation and withholding degrees. As Zeh discovered when he tried to publish his first paper on decoherence, physics journals were generally reluctant at best and hostile at worst when faced with submissions on the foundations of quantum physics. *Physical Review* actually had an explicit editorial policy barring papers on quantum foundations unless they could be related to existing experimental data or made new predictions that could be tested in the laboratory. “It should not be overlooked that physics